



STUDY IN GERMANY
G U I D E

Germany Application Checklist

The full step-by-step path for international students - from research to your first weeks in Germany.

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Note: figures (fees, blocked-account amount, deadlines) update over time. Always confirm the current numbers on the official German embassy and university websites before applying.

- ☐ **01** Decide on the field of study (engineering, business, sciences, etc.)
- ☐ **02** Research 5-10 German universities offering your program
- ☐ **03** Check application deadlines for winter (May-July) or summer (Nov-Jan) intake
- ☐ **04** Note tuition fees + semester contribution per university
- ☐ **05** Check if APS certificate is required for your country
- ☐ **06** Make a shortlist of 4-6 universities to apply to

TIP

Use the interactive saveable version at studyinggermanyguide.com/checklist - your progress stays in your browser, no signup needed.

- ☐ **01** Decide: IELTS, TOEFL or TestDaF based on your program
- ☐ **02** Book test date 2 months in advance
- ☐ **03** Buy practice materials (Cambridge IELTS, official TOEFL)
- ☐ **04** Take 2-3 mock tests at home
- ☐ **05** Sit the test (aim for IELTS 6.5+ overall)
- ☐ **06** Receive official score report (allow 2 weeks)

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- ☐ **01** Collect all academic transcripts (Bachelor's, FSc/12th, Matric/10th)
- ☐ **02** Get country-specific attestation (HEC Pakistan, APS India/Vietnam)
- ☐ **03** Get MOFA + German Embassy attestation if required
- ☐ **04** Get certified English translations (if originals are in another language)
- ☐ **05** Update CV in German style (1-2 pages, photo, structured)
- ☐ **06** Get 1-2 letters of recommendation
- ☐ **07** Write a strong motivation letter (1-2 pages)
- ☐ **08** Scan all documents at 300 DPI in color (PDF format)

TIP

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- ☐ **01** Register on uni-assist (if applying through them)
- ☐ **02** Create direct application accounts for universities
- ☐ **03** Pay application fee per university (around €75)
- ☐ **04** Upload all required documents
- ☐ **05** Submit application 6-8 weeks before deadline
- ☐ **06** Follow up on application status weekly
- ☐ **07** Receive admission letter (Zulassungsbescheid)

TIP

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- ☐ **01** Open a blocked account (Expatrio, Fintiba, or Coracle)
- ☐ **02** Transfer required amount: about EUR 11,904 for one year
- ☐ **03** Receive blocked account confirmation letter
- ☐ **04** Get pre-arrival health insurance (DR-WALTER, Mawista)
- ☐ **05** Calculate first 3 months extra budget (1500-2000 EUR)
- ☐ **06** Inform bank of foreign exchange transfer purpose

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- ☐ **01** Check appointment availability at German embassy
- ☐ **02** Book visa appointment 6-8 weeks in advance
- ☐ **03** Pay visa fee (around EUR 75)
- ☐ **04** Prepare visa application form (VIDEX)
- ☐ **05** Prepare 2 recent biometric photos (3.5 x 4.5 cm)
- ☐ **06** Compile all visa documents (admission, blocked account, insurance, finances)
- ☐ **07** Practice common visa interview questions
- ☐ **08** Attend visa interview at the embassy
- ☐ **09** Receive visa within 4-12 weeks

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- ☐ **01** Book one-way flight to Germany
- ☐ **02** Apply for university dorm (Studentenwerk)
- ☐ **03** Get international driving permit (if needed)
- ☐ **04** Inform your bank of travel and get a Wise account
- ☐ **05** Get an unlocked phone for German SIM
- ☐ **06** Pack winter clothes (Germany is cold October-March)
- ☐ **07** Get prescription medicines for the first 3 months
- ☐ **08** Make 5 copies of every important document

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- ☐ **01** Register at the Burgeramt within 14 days (Anmeldung)
- ☐ **02** Open a German bank account (N26 or Deutsche Bank)
- ☐ **03** Get a German SIM card (Aldi, O2 Prepaid)
- ☐ **04** Activate health insurance (public: TK, DAK)
- ☐ **05** Get a tax ID (Steuer-ID) - arrives by mail
- ☐ **06** Apply for residence permit (Aufenthaltstitel) within 90 days
- ☐ **07** Buy semester ticket for public transport
- ☐ **08** Attend university orientation week

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You finished the checklist - welcome to Germany.

Next reads on studyingermanyguide.com

- > **Universities directory** studyingermanyguide.com/universities
- > **Cost calculator (any currency)** studyingermanyguide.com/calculator
- > **Visa walkthrough** studyingermanyguide.com/visa
- > **Blocked-account comparison** studyingermanyguide.com/blocked-account
- > **Health-insurance comparison** studyingermanyguide.com/insurance
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STUCK SOMEWHERE? JUST ASK.

I read every message personally. WhatsApp +49 170 6963809, or email studyingermanyguide@gmail.com. Mention which step you are on and what is unclear - I will reply within 24 hours.

- Abban Nadeem, founder. Pakistani student in Ilmenau.

